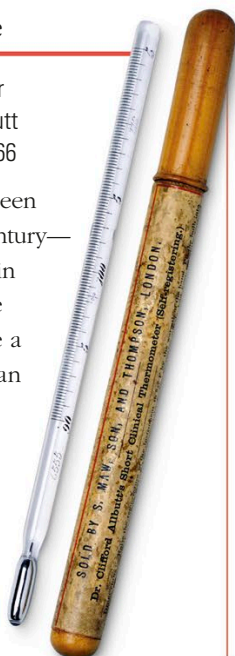


Taking temperature

- **What?** Clinical thermometer
- **Who?** Thomas Clifford Allbutt
- **Where and when?** UK, 1866

Medical thermometers had been invented by the mid-19th century—but they were more than 12in (30cm) long and could take up to 20 minutes to provide a reading. The British physician Thomas Allbutt improved their design by creating a thermometer that was half the size and gave a reading in just five minutes.

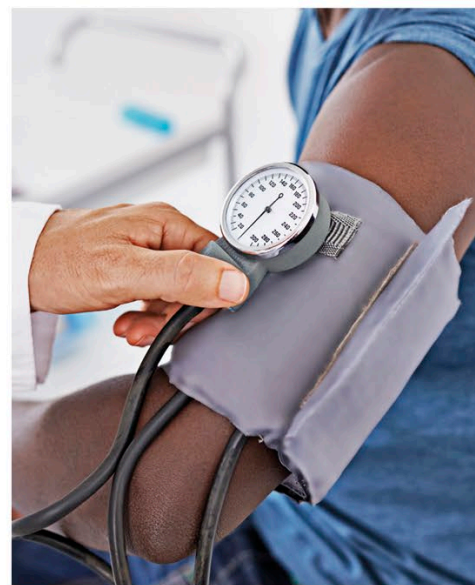
Allbutt's thermometer (left) and its case (right), c. 1880



Measuring blood pressure

- **What?** Sphygmomanometer
- **Who?** Samuel Siegfried Karl von Basch
- **Where and when?** Austria, 1881

The sphygmomanometer is a simple device that measures blood pressure. Created by an Austrian doctor, it was improved upon by the Italian doctor Scipione Riva Rocci, who added an inflatable cuff that wraps around a patient's arm. Inflating the cuff squeezes the arm, stopping blood flow. The cuff is then slowly deflated until the doctor hears the blood flowing again, and the meter records its pressure.

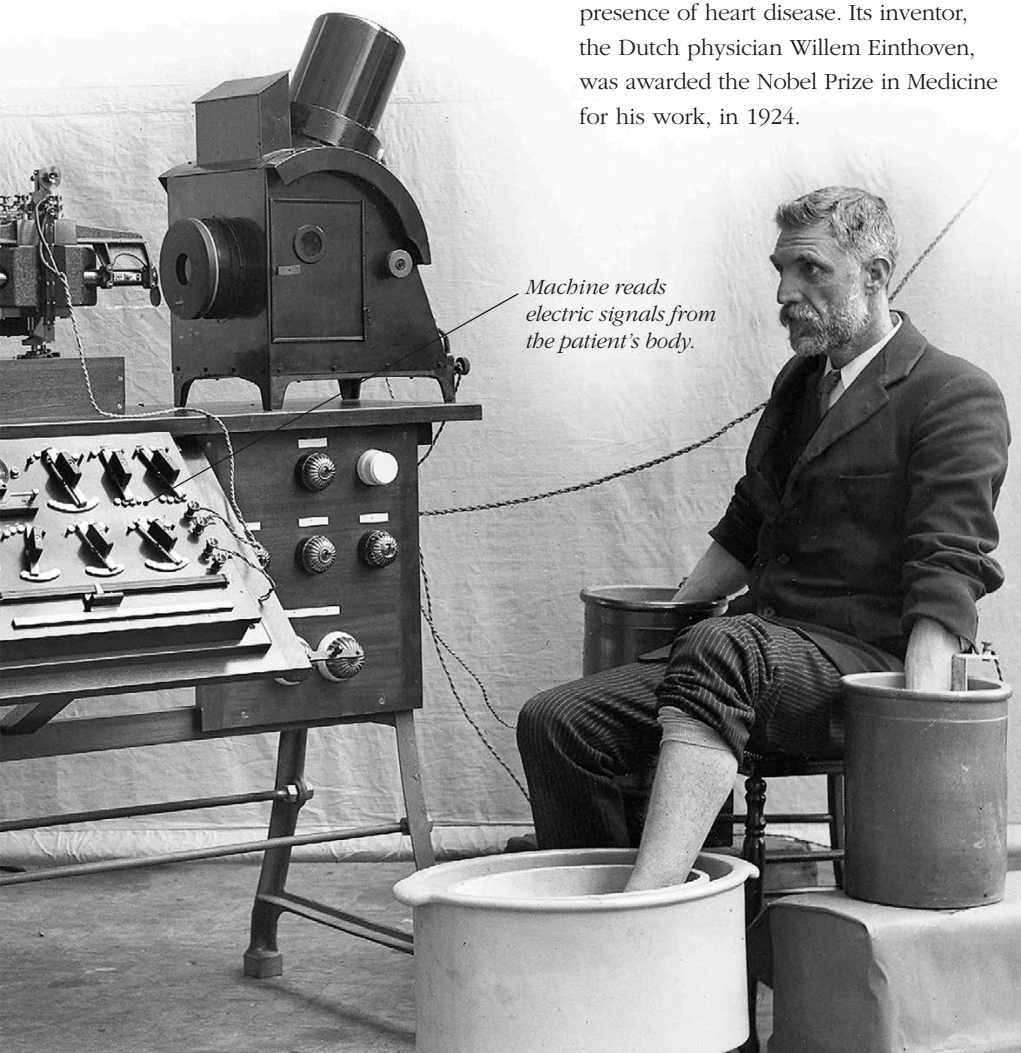


Modern sphygmomanometer

Measuring the heart's electrical activity

- **What?** Electrocardiograph (ECG or EKG)
- **Who?** Willem Einthoven
- **Where and when?** Netherlands, 1901

An electrocardiograph measures the small electric currents produced by the heart, which can help detect the presence of heart disease. Its inventor, the Dutch physician Willem Einthoven, was awarded the Nobel Prize in Medicine for his work, in 1924.



Checking blood sugar

- **What?** Blood-Glucose Meter
- **Who?** Anton "Tom" Clemens
- **Where and when?** US, 1966

People with diabetes (a disease in which blood sugar is not completely controlled) need to monitor their blood sugar levels. Until the 1960s, there was no easy way to do this. Then, an American engineer developed a device that could interpret the readings of glucose paper strips that change color based on how much sugar a drop of blood contains.



Modern blood sugar monitors can measure blood sugar digitally

◀ EARLY ECG

To use this ECG machine from 1911, patients had to put their limbs in buckets of salt water, which acted like electrodes, conducting the electricity.